

METRO AG SCI Project: Business Context

1. Company snapshot

METRO AG is a Düsseldorf-headquartered international wholesale group, dedicated since its strategic refocus to serving professional food-service customers and independent traders. As of fiscal year 2023/24, the group reported sales of approximately €31 billion, operated 624 wholesale stores in more than 30 countries across Europe and Asia, and employed around 90,000 people. The company serves approximately 15–17 million professional customers worldwide.

Indicator	Latest reported value (FY 2023/24)
Group sales	~€31 billion
Wholesale stores	624 stores, of which 522 OOS (Out-of-Store) locations + 94 depots
Countries of operation	~30 (Europe and Asia)
Employees	~90,000
Professional customers served	~15–17 million worldwide
Delivery (FSD) sales	€7.9 billion (+16.8% YoY)
METRO MARKETS marketplace sales	€0.2 billion (+49.3% YoY)

2. Business model

METRO operates a pure-play wholesale business model built on three complementary channels:

Cash-and-carry wholesale stores

The historical core: large-format membership-based wholesale stores where professional customers visit to purchase food and non-food products in bulk. Stores are increasingly being converted into Multichannel Fulfilment Centres (MFCs) that also serve as warehouses for delivery operations.

Food Service Distribution (FSD)

Direct delivery to HoReCa customers via METRO Delivery Service and a network of specialised delivery subsidiaries (Aviludo, Caterite, Classic Fine Foods, Johan i Hallen & Bergfalk, Pro à Pro, R Express). FSD is the fastest-growing channel and is targeted to more than triple by 2030.

Digital marketplace and platforms

METRO MARKETS — Europe's first B2B online marketplace dedicated to HoReCa equipment and non-food assortments — operates in Germany, Spain, the Netherlands, France, and additional European markets, with over 600,000 listed products. Complementary digital channels include the M|Shop ordering platform, the M|Companion mobile application, and the DISH suite of digital tools for hospitality operations (POS, payments, reservations).

3. Customer segments

METRO's customer base is exclusively professional (B2B). Three core segments structure the wholesale business:

Segment	Description
HoReCa (Hotel, Restaurant, Catering)	Professional hospitality businesses — restaurants, hotels, caterers, bars, canteens. The strategic priority segment under the sCore strategy. Together with Traders, accounted for 74% of sales in FY 2022/23, targeted to reach 80% by 2030.
Traders (Independent retailers)	Small and mid-sized independent retailers, kiosks, convenience stores. Served with assortments tailored to resale needs; supported by franchise solutions and private-label brands.
SCO (Service Companies and Offices)	Service businesses, offices, and other non-HoReCa professional buyers. A complementary segment, less central to the sCore strategy than HoReCa and Traders.

4. Strategic positioning — the sCore strategy

Announced in 2022 and consistently reiterated since, sCore ("score" + "core") is METRO's growth strategy through 2030. The name signals a dual commitment: hitting ambitious targets while sharpening focus on the wholesale core. The strategy rests on three pillars:

Pillar 1 — Sharpened focus on professional customers

Exit from non-core retail activities (the Real hypermarket business was divested), and concentration on HoReCa and Traders as the strategic customer base. Continuous optimization of product assortments, pricing models, and own-brand expansion (METRO Chef, METRO Professional, aro) — targeted to grow from ~25% to over 35% of total assortment.

Pillar 2 — Multichannel expansion

Systematic build-out of three complementary channels: stores transformed into Multichannel Fulfilment Centres, FSD scaled through targeted acquisitions and depot expansion, and the METRO MARKETS marketplace expanded internationally with the goal of reaching €3 billion in marketplace sales by 2030 (a roughly 60-fold increase from the starting point).

Pillar 3 — Digital transformation

Acceleration of digital sales as a share of total sales — from approximately 11% in 2021/22 to a target of 40% by 2030. Digital is positioned not only as a sales channel but as a retention and partnership lever, shifting the customer relationship from transactional to service-oriented.

Long-term financial ambition

Group sales to grow at 5–10% CAGR on average, reaching over €40 billion by 2030; adjusted EBITDA above €2 billion; FSD sales tripled; digital sales at 40% of total. The corporate tagline accompanying sCore — *"Wholesale to the max"* — frames this as a doubling-down on wholesale identity rather than

diversification.

5. Digital portfolio

METRO's digital capabilities are developed primarily through METRO.digital, the group's in-house technology subsidiary headquartered in Düsseldorf with engineering hubs in Berlin, Brasov, Bucharest, and Cluj-Napoca. The customer-facing digital portfolio — the explicit scope of this SCI project — includes:

Product	Function
E-commerce Platform (M Shop)	Web-based ordering platform translating in-store shopping to the online channel; available 24/7 to professional customers.
METRO MARKETS	Europe's first B2B online marketplace for HoReCa, with over 600,000 products. Operates in DE, ES, NL, FR, and additional EU markets. Strategic growth target: €3 billion in sales by 2030.
Mobile Commerce (M Companion)	Mobile application combining ecommerce access, in-store scan-and-search, loyalty points, coupons, and digital invoices. Over 300,000 active monthly users and over 90% reported user satisfaction.
DISH Digital Solutions	Standalone digital platform for the hospitality industry, providing POS systems (DISH POS), payments (DISH Pay), reservations, website tools, and operational applications. Acquired Eijsink (POS) in 2022 to strengthen the suite.
Order Fulfillment Suite	Software supporting order processing accuracy and speed across channels.
In-store Checkout Solutions	Customer-facing checkout tools deployed across stores.

Strategic role of the digital portfolio

Beyond serving as a sales channel, the digital portfolio plays three interconnected strategic roles: (1) **retention** — making METRO indispensable to daily HoReCa operations through embedded tools like DISH POS, with high switching costs; (2) **customer reach** — extending METRO's product range far beyond what physical stores can stock through the METRO MARKETS marketplace; and (3) **data and intelligence** — generating order, preference, and behavioral data that informs assortment, pricing, and customer service decisions.

Sources: METRO AG Annual Report 2023/24 (reports.metroag.de); METRO AG corporate website (metroag.de); METRO.digital product catalog (metro.digital); METRO AG newsroom and strategy announcements (newsroom.metroag.de). All figures refer to fiscal year 2023/24 unless otherwise specified.